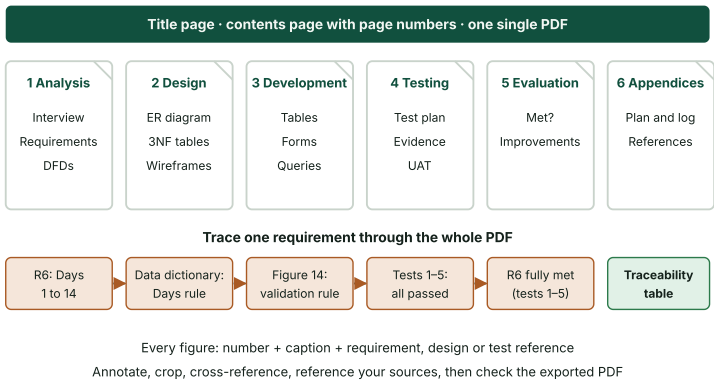
Producing the portfolio

AD06 FACT FILE

Specification: students should be able to

- Present the evidence of analysis, design, development, testing and evaluation as a single, well-organised PDF portfolio
- Annotate evidence clearly and cross-reference it to requirements, designs and tests
- Acknowledge sources and complete the authentication requirements

Key words: portfolio, PDF, contents page, section numbering, figure caption, cross-reference, annotation, appendix, bibliography, referencing, proofreading, checklist



The structure of the single PDF portfolio in six sections, and how one requirement is traced through every section by cross-references

Structuring the PDF

The A2 2 portfolio is submitted as a single PDF, so its organisation directly affects how easily evidence can be credited. A title page, a contents page with accurate page numbers, numbered sections following the system life cycle and consistent heading styles help the reader. Appendices hold supporting material such as the full interview transcript and the project log. Before submitting, export the PDF and check it opens correctly, the pages are in order and the images are clear.

Annotation and cross-referencing

Screenshots are the main evidence of development and testing, so they must be cropped, readable and annotated with callouts that highlight the relevant features. Each figure needs a number and a caption that names the requirement, design item or test it relates to. Cross-referencing these numbers throughout the portfolio allows a moderator to trace any requirement from analysis to evaluation. A traceability table summarising these links is a useful final check that nothing has been missed.

Referencing

All sources that informed the work, including tutorials, websites, templates, images and any permitted use of AI tools, must be acknowledged in a references section using a consistent style. This is part of authenticating the work as the candidate's own. Copying theory or text from websites adds nothing to the evidence and can be treated as plagiarism. Help from the teacher or others should be recorded as the centre requires, and the candidate declaration must be signed.

T Key terms from the mark schemes

Portfolio
The single PDF document containing all the candidate's evidence of analysis, design, development, testing and evaluation.

Traceability table
A table linking each requirement to its design, development, test and evaluation evidence.

Cross-reference
A reference from one part of the portfolio to another, such as a test number or figure number, so evidence can be traced.

Referencing
Acknowledging the sources used in a piece of work in a consistent format, so it is clear which work is the candidate's own.

Exam focus

Presentation does not replace content, but poor organisation can hide good work. Moderators look for clear, relevant evidence matched to the marking grid, so read the current grid and check every heading is covered. Remove padding such as long generic theory or repeated screenshots. Keep explanations concise and specific to your client. Proofread for spelling and technical accuracy, and check that the final PDF matches the version you intended to submit.

? Check yourself

1. State three features that make a PDF portfolio easy for a moderator to navigate. [3]
2. Describe how a screenshot should be presented as evidence of development. [3]
3. What is a traceability table and why is it useful? [2]

Answers: 1. Any three from: a title page (1) / a contents page with accurate page numbers (1) / numbered sections following the stages, e.g. 1 Analysis to 5 Evaluation (1) / PDF bookmarks or a linked contents page (1) / consistent headings, figure numbers and captions (1) / clearly labelled appendices (1) / page numbers on every page (1). 2. Any three from: cropped to the relevant part and readable at normal zoom (1) / annotated with callouts or arrows pointing to the key setting, e.g. a validation rule (1) / a figure number and caption naming the requirement, design item or test number (1) / a sentence or two explaining what it shows and why it was done (1) / show both design view/setup and the result (1). 3. A traceability table lists each requirement with references to where it is designed, developed and tested (and evaluated) (1) / it is a final check that no requirement has been missed and lets the moderator quickly trace and find the evidence for any requirement (1).